

IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-7959
Project Name	Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorming helps the team generate and compare possible solutions, then select practical ideas for the ServiceNow micro project.

STEP 1: TEAM GATHERING, COLLABORATION AND SELECT THE PROBLEM STATEMENT

Team goal: Move employee data from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow while reducing manual entry, preserving field accuracy, and making results easy to verify.

Selected problem statement: How might we import employee data from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow accurately and efficiently, map each source field to the correct target field, reduce duplicate records, and verify the imported data through reports?

Target users: ServiceNow administrators or support team members who maintain employee records from spreadsheets.

Key pain points

Manual effort	Entering employee records one by one takes time.
Data errors	Typing mistakes, inconsistent values, or missing fields affect record quality.
Duplicate records	Existing employees may be inserted again if matching is misconfigured.
Verification	Administrators need a clear way to check target records and summarize results.

STEP 2: BRAINSTORM, IDEA LISTING AND GROUPING

Ideas focus on data import, quality, duplicate handling, validation, reporting, and future automation.

Group	Idea	Expected benefit	Feasibility
Data import	Use an Import Set staging table to load spreadsheet rows.	Separates incoming data before transformation.	High
Field mapping	Create a Transform Map with five source-to-target field maps.	Transfers values to the correct target fields.	High
Duplicate handling	Configure coalesce using a stable, unique Employee ID.	Can update matching records instead of inserting duplicates.	Verify config
Data quality	Check required values, email format, and consistent department/location values.	Reduces incomplete or inconsistent records.	Medium
Validation	Compare source rows with the target table after transformation.	Helps identify missing or incorrect values.	High
Reporting	Create employee list, department, and location reports.	Makes imported data easier to review.	High
Automation	Schedule recurring imports for frequently updated spreadsheets.	Reduces repeated manual uploads.	Future
Monitoring	Track import errors and measure transform duration on larger datasets.	Improves operational visibility.	Future

Idea grouping

Core implementation	Import Set staging table, Transform Map, five field mappings, and target table.
Quality and safety	Employee ID uniqueness, coalesce behavior, and source-to-target value checks.
Presentation	Employees List, Employees by Department, and Employees by Location reports.
Future scope	Scheduled imports, error handling, and larger dataset performance testing.

STEP 3: IDEA PRIORITIZATION

Ideas are prioritized by impact, feasibility, and implementation effort. The core workflow is selected because it directly addresses the problem statement and is supported by the ServiceNow implementation evidence.

Prioritization matrix (conceptual)

High impact / low effort	High impact / high effort
A. Field mapping B. Data validation C. Coalesce by Employee ID (after verification)	D. Scheduled imports E. Advanced monitoring
Low impact / low effort	Low impact / high effort
F. Additional report styling	Large-scale performance testing

Priority	Idea	Reason	Decision
1 — Highest	Import Set + Transform Map + five field mappings	Core workflow required to transfer spreadsheet data.	Selected
2 — High	Validate target records against the spreadsheet	Confirms imported values are accurate and complete.	Selected
3 — High	Coalesce using unique Employee ID	Important for safe updates and duplicate prevention; verify configuration.	Check config
4 — Medium	Employee list, department, and location reports	Provides a simple way to review the results.	Implemented
5 — Later	Scheduled imports and automated error handling	Useful for repeated imports, but not essential to current demonstration.	Future scope

Selected solution and expected outcome

Upload the spreadsheet into Employee Import (u_employee_import), transform five mapped fields into Employee Test (u_employee_test), verify employee records, and review the data through three reports.

Implementation evidence: Five field mappings, six sample employee records (SB0001–SB0006), and three configured reports.

Configuration note: The screenshot shows coalesce enabled on Employee Name. If Employee ID is the unique identifier, verify and align this configuration before relying on duplicate prevention.

GitHub: [Import Data Using Transform Maps](#)

Demo: [Google Drive demo link](#)